

Transmission and Reflection Characteristics of Slightly Irregular Wire-Grids With Finite Conductivity for Arbitrary Angles of Incidence and Grid Rotation

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Abstract—In the first half of this paper, an efficient method to calculate transmission and reflection characteristics of wire-grids consisting of periodic arrays of cylindrical conductors for arbitrary directions of incidence is presented by extending exact theory of wire-grids proposed by Yasumoto *et al.* In the latter half of this paper, an approximate calculation method for wire-grids with slight random irregularity in their spacings between wires is proposed by treating the irregularity as a small perturbation to the theory for regular grids. A comparison with preliminary measurements for actual wire-grids in millimeter- and submillimeter-wave regions demonstrated that this method is effectively applicable to wire-grids whose irregularity is not too much.

Index Terms—Electromagnetic reflection, electromagnetic scattering by periodic structures, submillimeter wave devices, submillimeter wave measurements, wire grids.

I. INTRODUCTION

FREESTANDING wire-grids composed of an array of parallel conducting wires are widely used as quasi-optical components such as polarizers, beam splitters, or combiners with low loss and high polarization selectivity. In particular, in millimeter- and submillimeter-wave regions, they are indispensable not only as polarizers or beam combiners but also in such applications as quasi-optical filters, interferometers, and isolators [1]. Although there have been many different theoretical studies developed for predicting and analyzing the transmission and reflection characteristics of wire-grids, most of them, to the authors' knowledge, were approximate ones only applicable to the cases where the diameter of the wire is much smaller than the wavelength or the spacing between wires [2], [3].

It was only rather recently that more exact treatment of wire-grid without such approximations became possible by the Green-function method [4] or the lattice-sum method [5]. In the first half of this paper, a method for calculating transmission and reflection characteristics of wire-grids consisting of a periodic array of cylindrical conductors for arbitrary directions

of incidence and grid rotation is presented by extending a very accurate and efficient calculation method for wire-grids developed as a two-dimensional problem [5] based on the lattice-sum method proposed by Yasumoto *et al.* [6].

In most of the theories which include the one presented in the first half of this paper, the wire-grid has been assumed to be a periodic array of parallel cylindrical wires with a constant spacing between them. In actual wire-grids used in millimeter- and submillimeter-wave regions, the grids are never free from irregularity in wire spacing due to the difficulty in producing evenly spaced grids in manufacturing processes as the spacing decreases. It is experimentally known that the irregularity in wire spacing has some effects on the grid performance [1], [7]–[9]. There have been almost no detailed theoretical studies made about the effects of grid imperfection on its performance except the one by Houde *et al.* [10].

In the latter half of this paper, a perturbation theory for calculating the characteristics of wire-grid with slight random irregularity in its spacing is proposed. In this theory, the irregularity in wire-grid is modeled as random errors in wire positions from regular positions, and is treated as a perturbation to the exact theory of periodic wire-grid by assuming that the positional errors of wires are zero-mean statistically uncorrelated independent variables from wire to wire. The transmission and reflection characteristics of wire-grid are shown to be affected significantly by the grid irregularity when the incident wave has electric field component parallel to the grid wires (TM-wave incidence), while the grid irregularity has little effect on its characteristics when the electric field of the incident wave was perpendicular to the grid wires (TE-wave incidence).

In order to validate the applicability of the proposed theory for actual irregular wire-grid, the results of measurements of transmission and reflection coefficients we have made for actual wire-grids with different degrees of irregularity at millimeter and submillimeter wavelengths are compared with those of the theoretical calculations.

II. DEFINITION OF THE COORDINATE SYSTEM

In this paper, we define the coordinate systems as shown in Fig. 1 relating the geometry of the wire-grid and the incident wave as follows.

- The wire-grid is an array of parallel wires of radius a with a period h . The plane of wire-grid lies in the x - z plane.

Manuscript received August 5, 2003; revised January 4, 2004. The work of A. Murk was supported in part by the Swiss National Science Foundation under Grant 200020-100167.

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Digital Object Identifier 10.1109/TAP.2004.838786

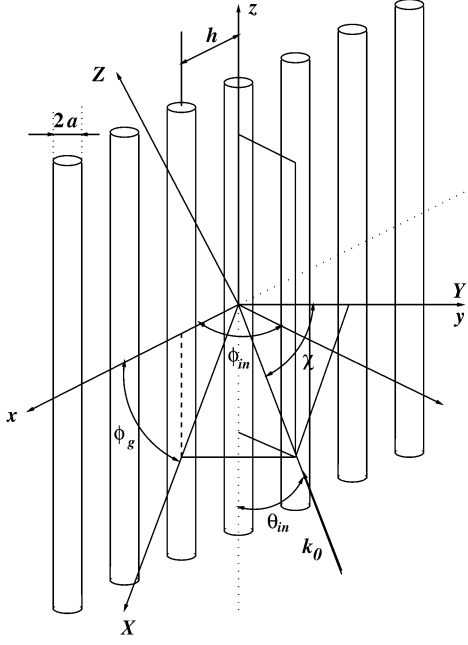


Fig. 1. Coordinate systems defining the configuration of wire-grid and the incident wave vector for $\mathbf{k}_0$.

Each wire supposed to be an infinitely long cylinder is directed along the z -axis.

- The plane of incidence in which the incident wavenumber vector $\mathbf{k}_0$ lies is defined as the X - Y plane ($Y \equiv y$) which is made by rotating the x - y plane by ϕ_g around the y -axis. We refer to the rotation angle ϕ_g as the grid rotation angle.
- The incident wavenumber vector $\mathbf{k}_0$ lying in the X - Y plane is given by $\mathbf{k}_0 = -i_X k_0 \sin \chi - i_Y k_0 \cos \chi$, where χ is the angle of incidence.

If we define the angles θ_{in} and ϕ_{in} as in Fig. 1 such that the incident wavenumber vector $\mathbf{k}_0$ is expressed in the (x, y, z) coordinate system as

$$\mathbf{k}_0 = -k_0 \sin \theta_{in} (\cos \phi_{in} \mathbf{i}_x + \sin \phi_{in} \mathbf{i}_y) + k_0 \cos \theta_{in} \mathbf{i}_z \quad (1)$$

the relationship between (χ, ϕ_g) and (θ_{in}, ϕ_{in}) can be written as

$$\theta_{in} = \cos^{-1}(\sin \chi \sin \phi_g) \quad (2)$$

$$\phi_{in} = \tan^{-1}(\cot \chi \sec \phi_g). \quad (3)$$

III. T-MATRIX OF ISOLATED CYLINDRICAL WIRE WITH FINITE CONDUCTIVITY FOR ARBITRARY ANGLE OF INCIDENCE

Before considering an array of cylinders, let us consider the scattering of a plane wave by a single isolated cylindrical wire whose axis coincides with the z -axis in Fig. 1. We refer to this cylinder as the zeroth cylinder in the following discussions.

In order for the theory to be applicable not only to metallic wires but also to dielectric cylinders, we assume that the material of wire is a lossy dielectrics characterized by a complex relative permittivity ϵ_r . When the material of the wire is a metallic

conductor with a finite conductivity σ , the complex relative permittivity given by $\epsilon_r = 1 + j\sigma/(\omega\epsilon_0)$ should be substituted.¹

A. Incident Wave

Let us decompose the field of the incident plane wave into the TM- and TE-wave components whose electric fields are polarized in a plane parallel and perpendicular to the direction of wire, respectively.

For the case of the TM incident plane wave, the incident field at a point (ρ_0, ϕ_0, z) in the cylindrical coordinate system can be generated, in a form that facilitates the application of boundary conditions at the surface of the wire, by the electric Hertz potential [11] given by

$$\begin{aligned} \Pi_{ez}^{in} &= \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} A^{in} \\ &\times e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{in}} J_n(k_0 \rho_0 \sin \theta_{in}) e^{jn(\phi_0 - \phi_{in} - \pi + (\pi/2))} \\ &= e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{in}} \mathbf{P}_0^T \cdot \mathbf{a}^{in} \end{aligned} \quad (4)$$

where $\mathbf{P}_0 = [J_n(k_0 \rho_0 \sin \theta_{in}) e^{jm\phi_0}]$ and $\mathbf{a}^{in}$ is the TM-incident-wave amplitude vector defined as

$$\mathbf{a}^{in} = A^{in} [(-j)^m e^{-jm\phi_{in}}] \quad (5)$$

and J_n is the Bessel function of order n . Here and subsequently, $[X_m]$ denotes a column vector having an infinite number of elements X_m ($m = 0, \pm 1, \pm 2, \dots$) and the superscript T denotes the transpose of the indicated vector. In (5), A^{in} is the incident field amplitude related with the incident electric field E^{in} by

$$A^{in} = \frac{E^{in}}{k_0^2 \sin \theta_{in}}. \quad (6)$$

On the other hand, for the case of the TE incident plane wave, the incident field can be generated by the electric Hertz potential given by

$$\Pi_{mz}^{in} = e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{in}} \mathbf{P}_0^T \cdot \mathbf{b}^{in} \quad (7)$$

where $\mathbf{b}^{in}$ is the TE-incident-wave amplitude vector defined as

$$\mathbf{b}^{in} = B^{in} [(-j)^m e^{-jm\phi_{in}}]. \quad (8)$$

In (8), B^{in} is the incident field amplitude related with the incident electric field E^{in} by

$$B^{in} = \frac{E^{in}}{\eta k_0^2 \sin \theta_{in}} \quad (9)$$

where $\eta (= \sqrt{\mu_0/\epsilon_0})$ is the impedance of free space.

B. Scattered Wave

We express the TM and TE components of the scattered wave by the electric Hertz potential Π_{ez}^{sc} and the magnetic Hertz potential Π_{mz}^{sc} , respectively, by using unknown coefficients A_m^{sc} and B_m^{sc} with the Hankel function of the first kind $H_m^{(1)}$ as

$$\Pi_{ez}^{sc} = e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{in}} \mathbf{Q}_0^T \cdot \mathbf{a}_0^{sc} \quad (10)$$

¹The time dependence of electromagnetic field is assumed to be $\exp(-j\omega t)$ and is omitted throughout this paper.

and

$$\Pi_{mz}^{\text{sc}} = e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{\text{in}}} \mathbf{Q}_0^T \cdot \mathbf{b}_0^{\text{sc}} \quad (11)$$

where $\mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}} = [(-j)^m A_m^{\text{sc}} e^{-jm\phi_{\text{in}}}]$, $\mathbf{b}_0^{\text{sc}} = [(-j)^m B_m^{\text{sc}} e^{-jm\phi_{\text{in}}}]$ and $\mathbf{Q}_0 = [H_m^{(1)}(k_0 \rho_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) e^{jm\phi_0}]$. The subscript “0” denotes the quantities with reference to the cylindrical coordinate system (ρ_0, ϕ_0, z) with the origin centered at the zeroth cylinder.

C. Field Inside the Wire

Inside the wire, we express the electric Hertz potential Π_{ez}^w and the magnetic Hertz potential Π_{mz}^w using the unknown coefficients A_m^w and B_m^w , respectively, as

$$\Pi_{ez}^w = e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{\text{in}}} \mathbf{W}_0^T \cdot \mathbf{a}_0^w \quad (12)$$

and

$$\Pi_{mz}^w = e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{\text{in}}} \mathbf{W}_0^T \cdot \mathbf{b}_0^w \quad (13)$$

where $\mathbf{a}_0^w = [(-j)^m A_m^w e^{-jm\phi_{\text{in}}}]$, $\mathbf{b}_0^w = [(-j)^m B_m^w e^{-jm\phi_{\text{in}}}]$, $\mathbf{W}_0 = [J_m^{(1)}(k_1 \rho_0 \sin \theta_1) e^{jm\phi_0}]$, $k_1 = \sqrt{\epsilon_r} k_0$, and $k_1 \sin \theta_1 = \sqrt{k_1^2 - k_0^2 \cos^2 \theta_{\text{in}}}$.

D. T-Matrix of an Isolated Cylindrical Wire

If we define the incident amplitude vector $\mathbf{a}^{\text{in}}$ and the scattered amplitude vector $\mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}}$ as

$$\mathbf{a}^{\text{in}} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{a}^{\text{in}} \\ \mathbf{b}^{\text{in}} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}} \\ \mathbf{b}_0^{\text{sc}} \end{pmatrix} \quad (14)$$

the T -matrix $\mathbf{T}$ which relates the scattered wave to the incident wave can be defined as

$$\mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}} = \mathbf{T} \mathbf{a}^{\text{in}}. \quad (15)$$

The elements of the T -matrix $\mathbf{T}$ can be obtained from the boundary conditions at the surface of the wire as described in Appendix A.

It should be noted that there exists coupling between the TM and TE components when $\theta_{\text{in}} \neq \pi/2$ for cylinders with finite conductivity, as is readily found from (53) in Appendix A.

IV. SCATTERING OF PLANE WAVE BY A REGULAR WIRE-GRID FOR ARBITRARY ANGLE OF INCIDENCE AND GRID ROTATION

Before considering irregular wire-grids, let us consider a regular wire-grid of a periodic array of equally spaced cylinders with a spacing of h as shown in Fig. 1. In this case, the x - y dependence $\Psi^{\text{sc}}(x, y)$ of the scattered field

$$\Psi^{\text{sc}}(x, y, z) = e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{\text{in}}} \Psi^{\text{sc}}(x, y) \quad (16)$$

at a point (x, y, z) outside the cylinders is given by using Floquet's theorem as

$$\Psi^{\text{sc}}(x, y) = \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \mathbf{Q}_l^T \cdot \mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}} e^{-jlk_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \cos \phi_{\text{in}}} \quad (17)$$

where

$$\mathbf{Q}_l = [H_n^{(1)}(k_0 \rho_l \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) e^{jn\phi_l}] \quad (18)$$

with $\rho_l = \sqrt{(x - lh)^2 + y^2}$ and $\phi_l = \cos^{-1}[(x - lh)/\rho_l]$. By using Gegenbauer's addition theorem [13] of the Hankel functions given as

$$\begin{aligned} & H_n^{(1)}(k_0 \rho_l \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) e^{jn\phi_l} \\ &= \sum_{m=-\infty}^{\infty} J_m(k_0 \rho_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) e^{jm\phi_0} H_{n-m}^{(1)}(k_0 h l \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \end{aligned} \quad (19)$$

$\mathbf{Q}_l$ is expressed as

$$\mathbf{Q}_l^T = \mathbf{P}_0^T \cdot \boldsymbol{\xi}_l \quad (l \neq 0) \quad (20)$$

where $\boldsymbol{\xi}_l$ is a matrix whose (m, n) element is given by

$$\xi_{l,mn} = H_{n-m}^{(1)}(k_0 h l \sin \theta_{\text{in}}). \quad (21)$$

If we decompose the total field as the sum of the field incident on the zeroth wire centered at the origin and the field scattered by this zeroth wire, the x - y dependence $\Psi(x, y)$ of the total field $\Psi(x, y, z) = \Psi(x, y) e^{jk_0 z \cos \theta_{\text{in}}}$ is given by

$$\Psi(x, y) = \mathbf{P}_0^T \cdot (\mathbf{a}^{\text{in}} + \mathbf{L} \cdot \mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}}) + \mathbf{Q}_0^T \cdot \mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}} \quad (22)$$

where the elements of $\mathbf{L}$ are the lattice sum defined as²

$$L_{m,n} = S_{m-n}(k_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}}, \phi_{\text{in}}) \quad (23)$$

with

$$\begin{aligned} & S_n(k_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}}, \phi_{\text{in}}) \\ &= \sum_{l=-\infty, l \neq 0}^{\infty} H_n^{(1)}(lk_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) e^{-jlk_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \cos \phi_{\text{in}}}. \end{aligned} \quad (24)$$

The first and the second terms of the right-hand side of (22) are regarded as the field incident on the zeroth wire and the field scattered by the zeroth wire, respectively.

By considering the coupling between the TM and TE components given in (15), the scattered field amplitude $\mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}}$ can be expressed as

$$\mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}} = \mathbf{T} \cdot (\mathbf{a}^{\text{in}} + \mathbf{\Lambda} \cdot \mathbf{a}_0^{\text{sc}}) \quad (25)$$

by using the T -matrix $\mathbf{T}$ for isolated single wire. In (25), $\mathbf{\Lambda}$ is the lattice-sum matrix given as follows:

$$\mathbf{\Lambda} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{L} & \mathbf{0} \\ \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{L} \end{pmatrix}. \quad (26)$$

²This kind of lattice sum is notorious for its slow convergence. For computationally efficient numerical calculation of this lattice sum, we have extended the method proposed by Yasumoto *et al.* to the cases of arbitrary angles of grid rotation as described in Appendix B.

By solving (25) in terms of α_0^{sc} , we obtain the scattered amplitude as³

$$\alpha_0^{\text{sc}} = (\mathbf{I} - \Upsilon \cdot \Lambda)^{-1} \cdot \Upsilon \cdot \alpha^{\text{in}}. \quad (27)$$

A. Reflected and Transmitted Waves

From the scattered amplitude α_0^{sc} obtained above, the TM components of the reflected wave Ψ^r and the transmitted wave Ψ^t can be obtained as follows:

$$\Psi_{\text{TM}}^r(x, y, z) = \sum_{\nu=-\infty}^{\infty} \mathbf{p}_{\nu}^T \cdot \alpha_0^{\text{sc}} e^{j(k_{x\nu}x + k_{y\nu}y + k_0z \cos \theta_{\text{in}})} \quad (28)$$

and

$$\Psi_{\text{TM}}^t(x, y, z) = \sum_{\nu=-\infty}^{\infty} (\delta_{\nu 0} + \mathbf{q}_{\nu}^T \cdot \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}) \times e^{j(k_{x\nu}x - k_{y\nu}y + k_0z \cos \theta_{\text{in}})} \quad (29)$$

where

$$\mathbf{p}_{\nu} = \begin{cases} \frac{2(-j)^m (k_{x\nu} + jk_{y\nu})^m}{hk_{y\nu}k_0^m \sin^m \theta_{\text{in}}} & (m \geq 0) \\ \frac{2j^{|m|} (k_{x\nu} - jk_{y\nu})^{|m|}}{hk_{y\nu}k_0^{|m|} \sin^{|m|} \theta_{\text{in}}} & (m < 0) \end{cases} \quad (30)$$

and

$$\mathbf{q}_{\nu} = \begin{cases} \frac{2(-j)^m (k_{x\nu} - jk_{y\nu})^m}{hk_{y\nu}k_0^m \sin^m \theta_{\text{in}}} & (m \geq 0) \\ \frac{2j^{|m|} (k_{x\nu} + jk_{y\nu})^{|m|}}{hk_{y\nu}k_0^{|m|} \sin^{|m|} \theta_{\text{in}}} & (m < 0) \end{cases} \quad (31)$$

with

$$k_{x\nu} = \frac{2\nu\pi}{h} - k_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \cos \phi_{\text{in}} \quad (32)$$

and

$$k_{y\nu} = \sqrt{k_0^2 \sin^2 \theta_{\text{in}} - k_{x\nu}^2}. \quad (33)$$

The TE components of the reflected wave Ψ^r and the transmitted wave Ψ^t can be obtained similarly just by replacing α_0^{sc} with β_0^{sc} in (28) and (29).

It should be noted that, if $h|\sin \theta_{\text{in}}|(1 + \cos \phi_{\text{in}}) < \lambda$, only the modes with $\nu = 0$ of the transmitted and reflected waves are propagated, and other modes with $\nu \neq 0$ are evanescent. In this particular case, the power reflection coefficient R and the power transmission coefficient T of the grid are given as

$$R_{\text{TM}} = |\mathbf{p}_0^T \cdot \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}|^2 \quad (34)$$

and

$$T_{\text{TM}} = |1 + \mathbf{q}_0^T \cdot \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}|^2 \quad (35)$$

for the TM components of reflected and transmitted waves, respectively. The power reflection coefficient R_{TE} and the power transmission coefficient T_{TE} for the TE components of reflected and transmitted waves can be obtained similarly by replacing α_0^{sc} with β_0^{sc} in (34) and (35).

³Recently a similar relationship between α_0^{sc} and α^{in} has been derived by Yasumoto and Jia [14] in different formalism. We confirmed that their expression is equivalent to (27).

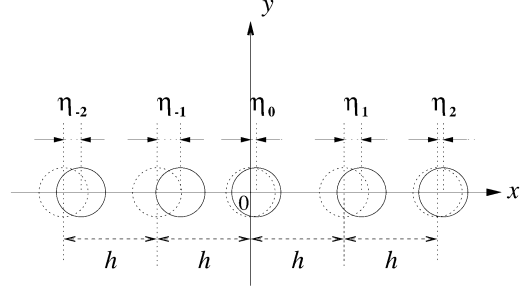


Fig. 2. Irregular wire-grid with random displacements of grid positions.

V. PERTURBATION THEORY FOR REFLECTION AND TRANSMISSION CHARACTERISTICS OF WIRE-GRIDS WITH SLIGHT IRREGULARITY IN WIRE SPACING

So far, we have assumed the wire-grid as a perfectly periodic array of equally spaced parallel cylindrical wires. In actual wire-grids used in millimeter- and submillimeter-wave regions, the grids are never free from irregularity in wire spacing due to the difficulty in producing evenly spaced grids in manufacturing process as the spacing decreases. In particular, for frequencies above 100 GHz, the diameters and the spacings of wire-grids are usually less than several tens of micrometers. In winding such wire-grids, it is almost impossible to reduce the irregularity in wire spacing to less than a few percent of the nominal spacing.

In this section, we consider an irregular wire-grid whose wire spacing is not perfectly uniform with slight random displacement of each wire position from its nominal position keeping the parallelism with each other. Although there might be other types of irregularity in wire-grids such as the nonuniformity in wire diameter or the nonflatness of the grid plane, experience shows that they are less significant as compared with the nonuniformity in wire spacing considering the usual fabrication method of freestanding wire-grids in which wire is wound on a precisely fabricated solid metallic frame. In this paper, we, therefore, focus on the effects of irregularity in wire spacing ignoring other irregularities.

Let the random irregularity in wire spacing of a wire-grid be given by a column vector $\boldsymbol{\eta} = (\dots, \eta_{-1}, \eta_0, \eta_1, \dots, \eta_l, \dots)^T$, where η_l is a random error in the x position of the center of the l th wire from the right position lh as shown in Fig. 2. The scattering amplitude of the zeroth wire given by (27) is modified for this irregular grid and can be expressed as

$$\alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta}) = (\mathbf{I} - \Upsilon \cdot \Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta}))^{-1} \cdot \Upsilon \cdot \alpha^{\text{in}} \quad (36)$$

where $\Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta})$ is the lattice-sum matrix for irregular grid given by replacing lh in the lattice sum matrix given by (26) through (24) with $lh + \eta_l$. If we assume the positional errors are small variables such that $\eta_l \ll h$ ($l = \dots - 1, 0, 1, \dots$), $\alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})$ can be approximated to the second order of $\boldsymbol{\eta}$ as

$$\alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta}) \simeq \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta} = 0) + \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \left. \frac{\partial \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})}{\partial \eta_l} \right|_{\boldsymbol{\eta}=0} \eta_l + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \left. \frac{\partial^2 \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})}{\partial \eta_l^2} \right|_{\boldsymbol{\eta}=0} \eta_l^2 \quad (37)$$

where the partial derivatives in the right-hand side of (37) can be obtained as follows after some algebra:

$$\frac{\partial \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})}{\partial \eta_l} = (I - \Upsilon \Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta}))^{-1} \Upsilon \frac{\partial \Lambda}{\partial \eta_l} \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta}) \quad (38)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial^2 \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})}{\partial \eta_l^2} = & \left[(I - \Upsilon \Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta}))^{-1} \Upsilon \frac{\partial^2 \Lambda}{\partial \eta_l^2} \right. \\ & \left. + 2 \left\{ (I - \Upsilon \Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta}))^{-1} \Upsilon \frac{\partial \Lambda}{\partial \eta_l} \right\}^2 \right] \\ & \cdot \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta}). \end{aligned} \quad (39)$$

If we assume that the positional errors of wires $(\dots, \eta_{-1}, \eta_0, \eta_1, \dots, \eta_l, \dots)$ are zero-mean statistically independent variables from wire to wire, the statistical properties of η_l can be written as

$$\overline{\eta_l^q} = 0 \text{ for } q = 1, 3, 5, 7, \dots \quad (40)$$

$$\overline{\eta_m^q} = \overline{\eta_n^q} \equiv \overline{\eta^q} \text{ for } \forall m, n \quad (41)$$

$$\overline{\eta_m^p \eta_n^q} = \overline{\eta_m^p} \overline{\eta_n^q} \text{ for } \forall m \neq n \quad (42)$$

where $\overline{x}$ denotes the ensemble average of x . By applying these properties to (37), we obtain the ensemble average of the scattering amplitude $\alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})$ as

$$\overline{\alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})} \simeq \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(0) + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\partial^2 \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})}{\partial \eta_l^2} \Big|_{\boldsymbol{\eta}=0} \overline{\eta^2} \quad (43)$$

where $\alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(0) \equiv \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta} = 0)$ and $\overline{\eta^2}$ is the variance of the random displacements of wires from their nominal positions.

By substituting (39) into (43), we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \overline{\alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(\boldsymbol{\eta})} \simeq & \left[1 + \frac{\overline{\eta^2}}{2} \left[(I - \Upsilon \Lambda(0))^{-1} \Upsilon \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\partial^2 \Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta})}{\partial \eta_l^2} \Big|_{\boldsymbol{\eta}=0} \right. \right. \\ & \left. \left. + 2 \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \left\{ (I - \Upsilon \Lambda(0))^{-1} \Upsilon \frac{\partial \Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta})}{\partial \eta_l} \Big|_{\boldsymbol{\eta}=0} \right\}^2 \right] \right] \alpha_0^{\text{sc}}(0). \end{aligned} \quad (44)$$

In (44), the partial derivatives are taken at $\boldsymbol{\eta} = 0$, and $\Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta})$ is given by

$$\Lambda(\boldsymbol{\eta}) = \begin{pmatrix} L(\boldsymbol{\eta}) & 0 \\ 0 & L(\boldsymbol{\eta}) \end{pmatrix} \quad (45)$$

where $L(\boldsymbol{\eta})$ is given by

$$\begin{aligned} L_{m,n}(\boldsymbol{\eta}) &= S_{m-n}(\boldsymbol{\eta}) \\ &= \sum_{l=-\infty, l \neq 0}^{\infty} H_{m-n}^{(1)}(k_0(lh + \eta_l) \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \\ &\quad \times e^{-jk_0(lh + \eta_l) \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \cos \phi_{\text{in}}}. \end{aligned} \quad (46)$$

With the aid of the recurrence formula and the Fourier integral representation of the Hankel functions as in [6], we can calculate the partial derivatives of the elements of the lattice-sum matrix by using

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial S_n}{\partial \eta_l} \Big|_{\boldsymbol{\eta}=0} &= (-1)^n \frac{j e^{jk_x h}}{k_0^n \sin^n \theta_{\text{in}}} \\ &\times \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{[\xi + j\kappa(\xi)]^m [k_x + \kappa(\xi)]}{\kappa(\xi)} e^{j\kappa(\xi) h} d\xi \end{aligned} \quad (47)$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\partial^2 S_n}{\partial \eta_l^2} \Big|_{\boldsymbol{\eta}=0} &= (-1)^{n+1} \frac{e^{jk_x h}}{\pi k_0^n \sin^n \theta_{\text{in}}} \\ &\times \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{[\xi + j\kappa(\xi)]^m [k_x + \kappa(\xi)]^2}{\kappa(\xi)} \frac{e^{j\kappa(\xi) h}}{1 - e^{j[k_x + \kappa(\xi)] h}} d\xi \end{aligned} \quad (48)$$

where

$$k_x = -k_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \cos \phi_{\text{in}} \quad (49)$$

and

$$\kappa(\xi) = \begin{cases} \sqrt{k_0^2 \sin^2 \theta_{\text{in}} - \xi^2} & \text{for } k_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \geq |\xi| \\ j \sqrt{\xi^2 - k_0^2 \sin^2 \theta_{\text{in}}} & \text{for } k_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}} < |\xi|. \end{cases} \quad (50)$$

Once the scattered amplitude vector $\overline{\alpha_0^{\text{sc}}}$ is obtained from (44), the reflection and transmission coefficient of the irregular wire-grid can be obtained from (34), (35), and corresponding equations for the TE components with (44) and (14).

VI. COMPARISON OF NUMERICAL CALCULATIONS WITH MEASUREMENTS

To validate the effectiveness of the proposed theory in estimating the characteristics of practical freestanding wire-grids, results of numerical calculations are compared with results of measurements made for actual wire-grids with different irregularities.

The conditions for the numerical calculations and the measurements were as follows.

- Material of wires: tungsten ($\sigma^{-1} = 5.5 \times 10^{-8} \Omega \text{m}$ [1]).
- Wire diameter: $2a = 10 \mu\text{m}$, the nominal spacing between wires: $h = 25 \mu\text{m}$.
- Angle of incidence: $\chi = 45^\circ$.
- Two different cases of the grid rotation angle were investigated: the plane of incidence was perpendicular ($\phi_g = 0^\circ$, denoted as G_{perp}), or parallel ($\phi_g = 90^\circ$, denoted as G_{para}) to the orientation of grid wires.
- Two different cases of incident polarization were investigated: the incident electric field was perpendicular (denoted as E_{perp}) or parallel (denoted as E_{para}) to the plane of incidence.

Measurements were made for two wire-grids with different degree of irregularity. We, hereafter, refer to the one with less irregularity as Grid #1 and to the other as Grid #2. Fig. 3(a1) and (a2) shows the microscopic images of the grid planes of Grid #1 and Grid #2, respectively. In Fig. 3(b1) and (b2), the displacements of wires from their nominal positions measured from the microscopic images are plotted versus wire number. Their probability distributions of Grid #1 and Grid #2 are shown in Fig. 3(c1) and (c2). From Fig. 3(c1) and (c2), the standard deviations σ_η ($= \sqrt{\overline{\eta^2}}$) of the displacements of wires from their nominal positions are estimated to be 23% and 52%, respectively, of the nominal wire spacing ($h = 25 \mu\text{m}$).

Fig. 4(a) and (b) shows the transmission and reflection coefficients, respectively, for the case of TE-wave incidence where the incident electric field is orthogonal to the direction of wires.

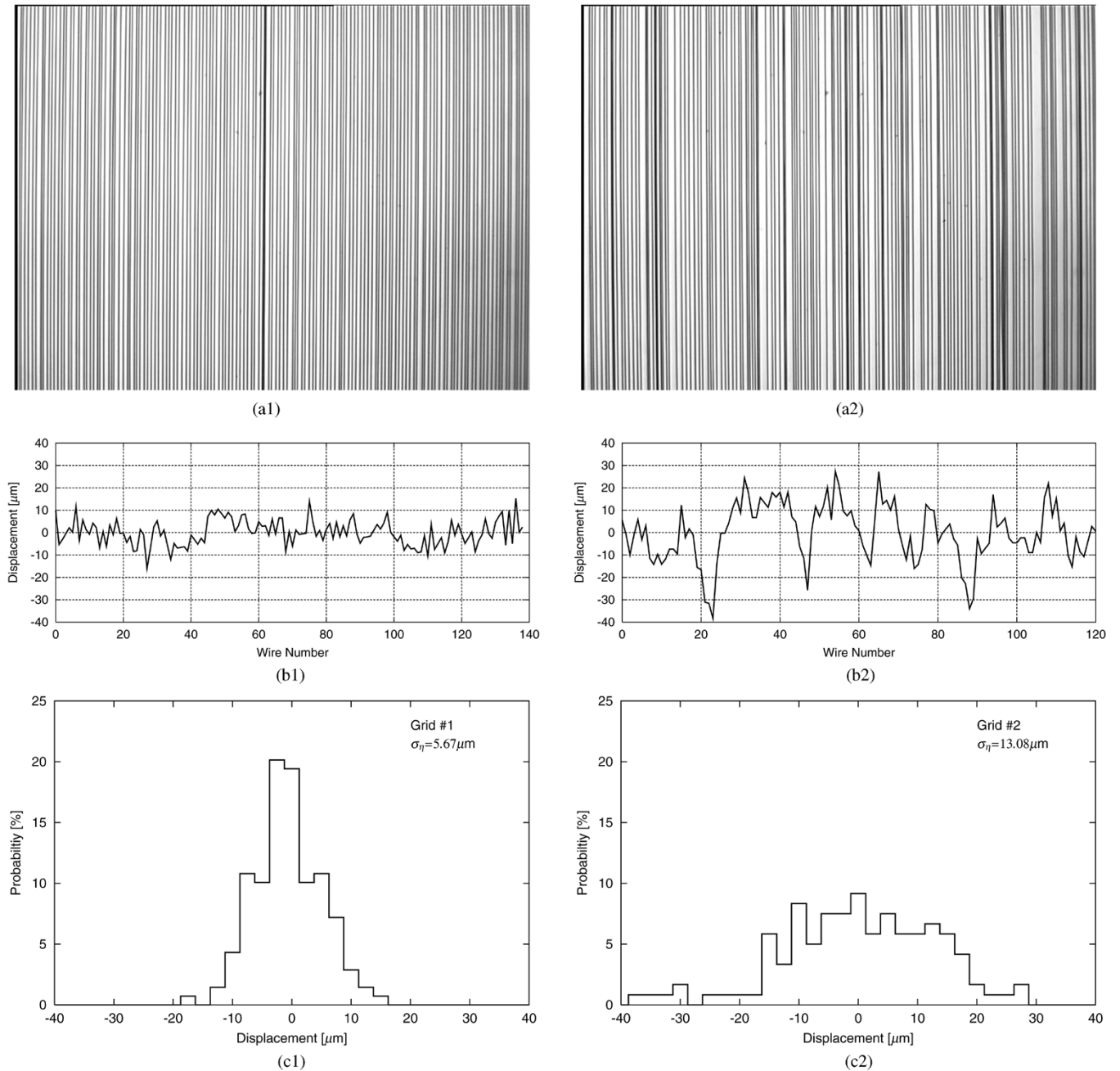


Fig. 3. Microscopic images of measured Grid #1 (a1) and Grid #2 (a2), displacements of wires from nominal positions of Grid #1 (b1) and Grid #2 (b2), and their probability distributions of Grid #1 (c1) and Grid #2 (c2).

The solid curves show the characteristics calculated for ideal grid without irregularity, and the dashed, dash-dot, and dotted curves show the characteristics calculated for irregular grids whose irregularities σ_η are assumed to be 20% ($\sigma_\eta = 0.20h$), 40% ($\sigma_\eta = 0.40h$), and 50% ($\sigma_\eta = 0.50h$) of the nominal wire spacing. Calculated results are shown for two different grid rotation angles $\phi_g = 0^\circ$ (denoted as G_{perp}) and 90° (denoted as G_{para}) by thin and thick curves, respectively. In these figures, E_{perp} and E_{para} denote the characteristics for the transmitted or reflected electric field component perpendicular and parallel to the plane of incidence, respectively. Measurement results for Grid #1 and Grid #2 are also shown in these figures. The corresponding results of calculations and measure-

ments for the case of TM-wave incidence are also shown in Fig. 5(a) and (b).

By comparing Figs. 4 and 5, it is found that the transmission and reflection characteristics of wire-grid are significantly affected by the grid irregularity when the incident wave has electric field component parallel to the grid wires (TM-wave incidence) as shown in Fig. 5, while the grid irregularity has little effect on its characteristics when the electric field of the incident wave was perpendicular to the grid wires (TE-wave incidence) as shown in Fig. 4.

Fig. 6(a) and (b) shows the dependence of the transmission and reflection coefficients on the grid irregularity σ_η calculated at 625 GHz. These figures also clearly demonstrate the differ-

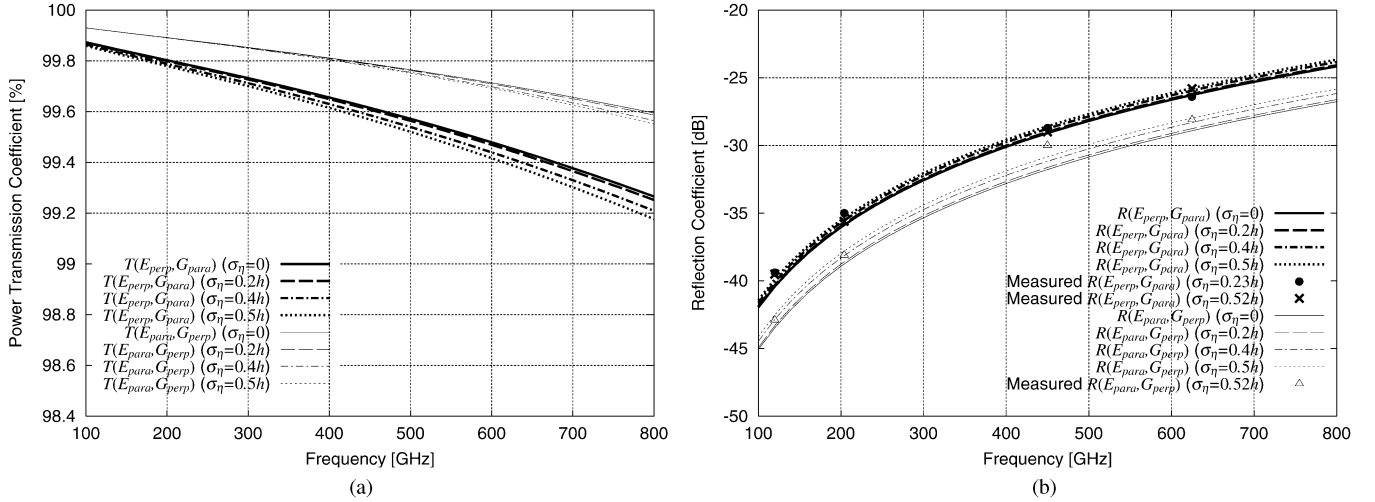


Fig. 4. Power transmission (a) and reflection (b) coefficients of regular ($\sigma_\eta = 0$) and irregular wire-grids for TE-wave incidence. Wire diameter: $2a = 10 \mu\text{m}$, wire pitch: $h = 25 \mu\text{m}$, angle of incidence: $\chi = 45^\circ$. E_{perp} and E_{para} denote the cases that the incident electric field is perpendicular and parallel to the plane of incidence, respectively. G_{perp} and G_{para} denote the cases that the wire is perpendicular ($\phi_g = 0^\circ$) and parallel ($\phi_g = 90^\circ$) to the plane of incidence, respectively.

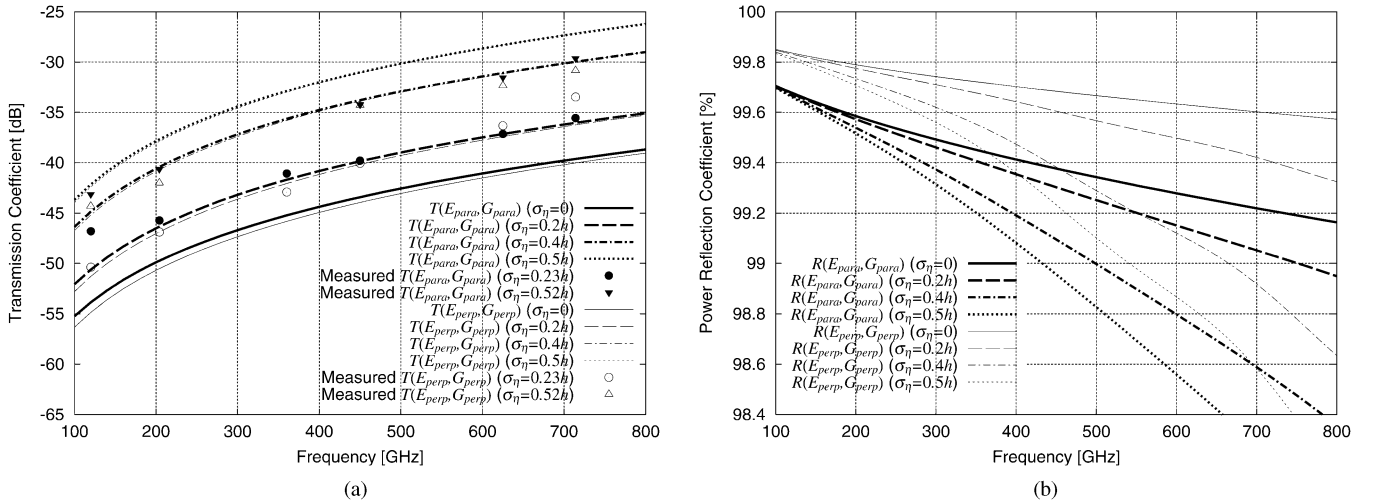


Fig. 5. (a) Power transmission and (b) reflection coefficients of regular ($\sigma_\eta = 0$) and irregular wire-grids for TM-wave incidence. Same as in Fig. 4.

ence in the dependence of the transmission and reflection characteristics on the grid irregularity between the TE-wave incident cases $[(E_{\text{perp}}, G_{\text{para}})]$ and $[(E_{\text{para}}, G_{\text{perp}})]$ and the TM-wave incident cases $[(E_{\text{para}}, G_{\text{para}})]$ and $[(E_{\text{perp}}, G_{\text{perp}})]$. This can be explained by the fact that large currents are effectively induced on grid wires in the TM-wave incident case where the incident wave has a electric field component parallel to the wires, while currents are not effectively induced on grid wires in the TE-wave incident case where the incident wave does not have electric field component parallel to the wires.

It is found that irregularities in wire spacing slightly reduce the total power $R + T$ in the plane-waves that are transmitted and reflected by a grid in the mode with $\nu = 0$. The lost power is diffusely scattered out of the regular transmission and reflection modes with $\nu = 0$ and constitutes nondirectionality scattered incoherent fields due to random nature of irregularity. Since we are considering coherently transmitted and reflected amplitudes by taking ensemble average in (43), the diffusely

scattered fields do not appear explicitly in the theoretical formulation in Section V.

Measurement results for Grid #1 and Grid #2 are also shown in Figs. 4(b), 5(a), and 6(b) for comparison. From comparison between these measurement and calculation results, it is found that the measurement results for Grid #1 whose standard deviation of wire position irregularity σ_η was 23% of the nominal wire spacing h agrees well with the theoretically calculated characteristics for $\sigma_\eta = 0.20h$. For the more irregular Grid #2 whose standard deviation of wire position irregularity was 52% of h , the general trend of the different dependence of the characteristics on the grid irregularity between the TM- and TE-wave incident cases agrees well with the measurement results, although the theoretical calculation results are found to overestimate the effects of irregularity as compared with the measurement results. This suggests that the irregularity of 52% of wire spacing might be too large for the perturbation theory of irregular grid presented in Section V to be applicable.

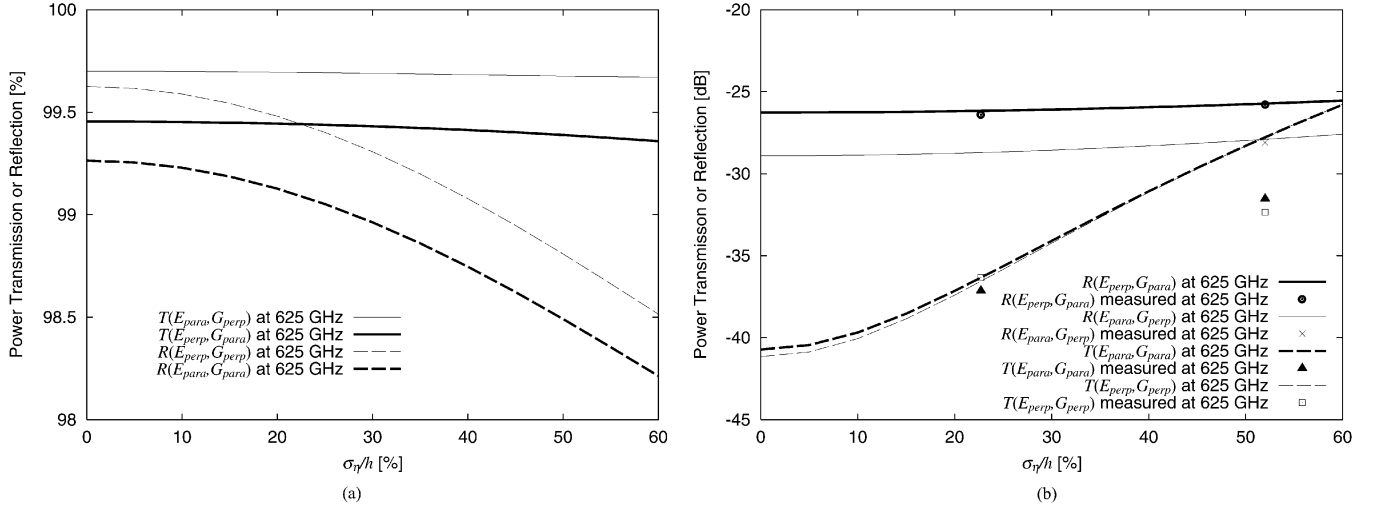


Fig. 6. Dependence of (a) power transmission and (b) reflection coefficients at 625 GHz on grid irregularity σ_η . Wire diameter: $2a = 10 \mu\text{m}$, wire pitch: $h = 25 \mu\text{m}$, frequency: 625 GHz, angle of incidence: $\chi = 45^\circ$. E_{perp} and E_{para} denote the cases that the incident electric field is perpendicular and parallel to the plane of incidence, respectively. G_{perp} and G_{para} denote the cases that the wires are perpendicular ($\phi_g = 0^\circ$) and parallel ($\phi_g = 90^\circ$) to the plane of incidence, respectively.

VII. CONCLUSION

In the first half of this paper, an accurate and computationally efficient method was presented for calculating the transmission and reflection characteristics of wire-grids of a periodic array of cylinders for arbitrary angles of incidence and grid rotation.

In the latter half of this paper, a method to calculate the effects of slight irregularity in wire spacing of grid was proposed by treating the irregular displacements of wire positions as a small perturbation to the theory of regular grid derived in the first half of this paper. Measurements made for actual wire-grids in millimeter- and submillimeter wavelengths have demonstrated that this perturbation theory was applicable to slightly irregular wire-grids whose standard deviation of the displacements of wire positions is less than about 30% of the nominal wire spacing.

Since the proposed calculation method can accurately estimate the detailed characteristics of realistic wire-grids with slight irregularity in wire spacing, it will be of practical use in designing and analyzing the characteristics of such quasioptical devices employing freestanding wire-grids as Martin–Puplett interferometers [15] and other polarizers and interferometers [16]. Although the results of numerical calculations and measurements are only shown for wire-grids consisting of an array of metallic cylindrical wires with finite conductivity in this paper, it is worthwhile noting that the proposed calculation method is applicable not only to arrays of conductive cylinders but also to general cases of arrays of dielectric cylinders by substituting the dielectric permittivity of the material for ϵ_r .

APPENDIX A

A. Boundary Conditions at the Surface of a Cylindrical Wire and its T -Matrix

The relations between the incident and scattered amplitudes for a single isolated cylinder are derived from the boundary con-

ditions on the surface of the cylinder for each mode m as follows [12]:

$$\mathbf{M}^{(m)} \begin{pmatrix} A_m^{\text{sc}} \\ A_m^{\text{w}} \\ B_m^{\text{sc}} \\ B_m^{\text{w}} \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{N}^{(m)} \begin{pmatrix} A^{\text{in}} \\ B^{\text{in}} \end{pmatrix} \quad (51)$$

where the elements of the 4×4 matrix $\mathbf{M}^{(m)}$ and the 4×2 matrix $\mathbf{N}^{(m)}$ are given as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} M_{11}^{(m)} &= M_{23}^{(m)} = k_0^2 \sin^2 \theta_{\text{in}} H_m^{(1)}(k_0 a \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \\ M_{12}^{(m)} &= M_{24}^{(m)} = -k_1^2 \sin^2 \theta_1 J_m(k_1 a \sin \theta_1) \\ M_{13}^{(m)} &= M_{14}^{(m)} = M_{21}^{(m)} = M_{22}^{(m)} = 0 \\ M_{31}^{(m)} &= M_{43}^{(m)} = -\frac{k_0 m \cos \theta_{\text{in}}}{a} H_m^{(1)}(k_0 a \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \\ M_{32}^{(m)} &= M_{44}^{(m)} = \frac{k_0 m \cos \theta_{\text{in}}}{a} J_m(k_1 a \sin \theta_1) \\ M_{33}^{(m)} &= -j\omega\mu_0 k_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}} H_m^{(1)'}(k_0 a \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \\ M_{34}^{(m)} &= j\omega\mu_0 k_1 \sin \theta_1 J_m'(k_1 a \sin \theta_1) \\ M_{41}^{(m)} &= j\omega\epsilon_0 k_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}} H_m^{(1)'}(k_0 a \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \\ M_{42}^{(m)} &= -j\omega\epsilon_r \epsilon_0 k_1 \sin \theta_1 J_m'(k_1 a \sin \theta_1) \\ N_{11}^{(m)} &= N_{22}^{(m)} = -k_0^2 \sin^2 \theta_{\text{in}} J_m(k_0 a \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \\ N_{12}^{(m)} &= N_{21}^{(m)} = 0 \\ N_{31}^{(m)} &= N_{42}^{(m)} = \frac{k_0 m \cos \theta_{\text{in}}}{a} J_m(k_0 a \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \\ N_{32}^{(m)} &= j\omega\mu_0 k_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}} J_m'(k_0 a \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) \\ N_{41}^{(m)} &= -j\omega\epsilon_0 k_0 \sin \theta_{\text{in}} J_m'(k_0 a \sin \theta_{\text{in}}). \end{aligned}$$

If we define the T -matrix relating the m th mode of scattered amplitudes with the incident amplitude as

$$\begin{pmatrix} A_m^{\text{sc}} \\ B_m^{\text{sc}} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} T_{AA}^{(m)} & T_{AB}^{(m)} \\ T_{BA}^{(m)} & T_{BB}^{(m)} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} A^{\text{in}} \\ B^{\text{in}} \end{pmatrix} \quad (52)$$

the T -matrix can be obtained by using the boundary condition given in (51) as

$$\begin{pmatrix} T_{AA}^{(m)} & T_{AB}^{(m)} \\ T_{BA}^{(m)} & T_{BB}^{(m)} \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{U} \mathbf{M}^{(m)-1} \mathbf{N}^{(m)} \quad (53)$$

where

$$U_{11} = U_{23} = 1 \quad (54)$$

$$U_{12} = U_{13} = U_{14} = U_{21} = U_{22} = U_{24} = 0. \quad (55)$$

If we define the incident amplitude vector $\boldsymbol{\alpha}^{\text{in}}$ and the scattered amplitude vector $\boldsymbol{\alpha}_0^{\text{sc}}$ as defined by (14), the T -matrix defined by (15) relating these incident and scattered amplitude vectors can be expressed as

$$\boldsymbol{\Upsilon} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{T}^{(AA)} & \mathbf{T}^{(AB)} \\ \mathbf{T}^{(BA)} & \mathbf{T}^{(BB)} \end{pmatrix} \quad (56)$$

where the elements of $\boldsymbol{\Upsilon}$ are given by using the elements of the T -matrix for the m th mode given in (53) as

$$T_{mn}^{(AA)} = \delta_{mn} T_{AA}^{(m)}, \quad T_{mn}^{(AB)} = \delta_{mn} T_{AB}^{(m)} \quad (57)$$

$$T_{mn}^{(BA)} = \delta_{mn} T_{BA}^{(m)}, \quad T_{mn}^{(BB)} = \delta_{mn} T_{BB}^{(m)}. \quad (58)$$

APPENDIX B

A. Lattice Sum for Arbitrary Angle of Grid Rotation

The sum of the infinite series in the right-hand side of (24) is usually referred to as the lattice sum, and is notorious for its desperately slow convergence in problems of periodic Green's functions. Yasumoto *et al.* have proposed a very efficient numerical method for calculating this lattice sum by using the Fourier integral representation of the Hankel functions [6], and have applied this method to the problem of periodic arrays of cylinders for the case when the plane of incidence is orthogonal to direction of cylinders [5].

In this paper, we extend their method to the cases when the incident plane wave arriving from arbitrary direction by modifying (18) of [6] by taking account of the angular dependence on θ_{in} as

$$\begin{aligned} & \sum_{l=1}^{\infty} H_n^{(1)}(lk_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}}) e^{\mp j l k_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \cos \phi_{\text{in}}} \\ &= \frac{(-1)^n}{\pi} e^{-j((\pi/4) \pm k_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \cos \phi_{\text{in}})} \int_0^a [G_n(\tau) + G_n(-\tau)] \\ & \quad \times \frac{e^{j k_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}} \sqrt{1-\tau^2}}}{\sqrt{1-\tau^2} [1 - e^{j k_0 h \sin \theta_{\text{in}} (\sqrt{1-\tau^2} \mp \cos \phi_{\text{in}})}]} d\tau \quad (59) \end{aligned}$$

where $G_n(\tau) = (\tau + j\sqrt{1-\tau^2})^n$ and $\tau = (1-j)t/\sqrt{2}$. With the aid of this formula, the lattice sum in (24) can be efficiently calculated by numerical integration as described in [5] and [6].

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The authors would like to thank Prof. K. Yasumoto of Kyushu University for his elucidating comments and discussions on the use of an efficient calculation method that utilizes the lattice sums and T -matrix developed by him. They also thank Dr. J. Inatani and the members of JEM/SMILES Mission Team of Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency and the National Institute of Information and Communications Technology for their useful discussions and support.

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